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Institutional Resilience: Illustrative Examples

THIS BOOK makes ambitious arguments about the relationship between IOs and populism, positing that IOs adopt strategies of appeasement and sidelining to withstand populist resistance and maintain their resilience. This chapter examines these claims by tracing how IOs have navigated populist challenges and assessing whether these strategies have been effective.

While we cannot definitively determine what actions IOs would have taken in the absence of populist threats, our focus is to evaluate whether populists have meaningfully weakened these organizations, and if so, to what extent. To do this, we analyze prominent instances of populist resistance, as these represent cases with strong potential for populists to harm IOs. The evidence shows that IOs have largely demonstrated creativity and resilience in maneuvering around these challenges, often mitigating potential damage effectively. This helps explain how and why IOs have persisted in the face of mounting resistance.

Importantly, this chapter provides evidence extending beyond IOs that operate in international finance. Much of the empirical evidence presented so far has centered on IFIs, which ensures coherence and comparability with existing research. In this chapter, we broaden the scope by exploring examples beyond the financial domain to demonstrate the broader